



NATIONAL MIGRATION POLICY REVISED EDITION 2025

AT A GLANCE

Introduction

Migration in Nigeria presents a complex interplay of internal, regional, and global movements, contributing to both the nation's development and its international relationships. While diaspora remittances, skills transfer, and labour mobility in and out of Nigeria generate significant benefits, challenges such as irregular migration, trafficking in person, smuggling of migrants, displacement, and climate-induced movements continue to test migration governance systems.

To address these dynamics, Nigeria adopted its first National Migration Policy (NMP) in 2015, establishing a framework for coordinated migration management and alignment with regional and global commitments. The policy strengthened institutional coordination and promoted multi-stakeholder engagement through mechanisms such as the National Migration Governance Structure and the National Migration Dialogue (NMD). In 2025, the NMP was revised following broad consultations to reflect emerging realities. The revised policy, together with its Integrated Implementation Plan (IIP), now provides Nigeria with a comprehensive and forward-looking framework for safe, orderly, and development-oriented migration governance.



Purpose of Review

The revision responded to emerging national, regional and global migration realities including economic pressures, conflict-induced displacement, rising irregular migration and Trafficking in Persons trends, evolving labour mobility patterns, the "Japa" phenomenon, the need for stronger gender responsiveness, inclusivity, and evidence-based planning and the need for improved coordination across all levels of governance.

The Review Process

The review was led by the Technical Working Group (TWG) of the national migration governance mechanism and coordinated by the National Commission for Refugees, Migrants and Internally Displaced Persons (NCFRMI) with the supervision of the Federal Ministry of Humanitarian Affairs and Poverty Reduction (FMHAPR) and the technical support of the International Organization for Migration within the Migration Multi-Partners Trust Fund of the United Nations Network on Migration (MMPTF-UNNM). It involved wide-ranging consultations with stakeholders from national and zonal government institutions, civil society, academia, the private sector, the media, trade unions, development partners, and migrant communities. The participatory process ensured that the revised policy is rights-based, gender-responsive, and inclusive, grounded in evidence-based data and shaped by local, national and international perspectives.

Policy's Vision, Objectives & Principles

Vision The policy envisions a sustainable migration governance for national and human development



OBJECTIVE

The Revised National Migration Policy of Nigeria provides for an effective management of migration that enhances national development, safeguards migrant rights, and promotes collaboration, cooperation and coordination among state and non-state actors and international partners for sustainable migration governance.

HUMAN RIGHTS & DISCRIMINATION

This Policy ensures the protection of the rights of all migrants and members of their families against exploitative labour, human trafficking, smuggling, discrimination, and other forms of human rights violations.

COHERENCE

This Policy aligns and complies with global, regional, sub-regional and national legal and normative frameworks for migration management, sustainable national and human development.

INCLUSIVITY

This Policy takes an all-inclusive approach ensuring equal access to opportunities and resources, thus, adopts gender responsiveness, child sensitivity and recognizes the marginalised and vulnerable groups including PWDs and older persons.

MULTI-SECTORAL PARTNERSHIP

The Policy provides for the engagement of all relevant sectors and adopts the whole-of-government and whole-of-society approach.

NATIONAL SECURITY, SOVEREIGNTY & IDENTITY

This Policy upholds national sovereignty and identity, promotes national security while acknowledging the rights and freedom of migrants.

PARTNERSHIP

This Policy recognizes the need for cooperation amongst countries and various actors in managing migration in a mutually beneficial manner.

DATA DRIVEN DECISION MAKING

This policy emphasises the collection, analysis, and utilisation of reliable and disaggregated data to inform evidence based migration management.

Policy Policy Priorities



Facilitating Regular Migration, Labour Mobility and Developmental Benefits of Migration: Promotes safe, orderly, and regular migration channels, harnessing diaspora contributions and labour mobility for Nigeria's economic and social development



Protecting Migrants' Rights and Safety: Ensures the protection of migrants' human rights, addressing vulnerabilities related to exploitation, trafficking, discrimination, and lack of access to services



Strengthening Integrated Border Management System for National Security and Safe Migration: Enhances coordinated and technology-driven border governance to safeguard national security while ensuring the smooth movement of people and goods



Promoting Dignified Return, Readmission, and Sustainable Reintegration: Provides structured frameworks for voluntary and humane return, readmission, and reintegration support that enable returnees to rebuild livelihoods and reintegrate into society



Advancing Evidence-Based Migration Discourse, Policy, and Planning: Strengthens migration data collection, research, and analysis to guide informed decision-making, policy formulation, and effective programme design



Crosscutting Themes – Gender, Youth and Child, Persons with Disabilities, Older Persons, and Cooperation and Coordination: Mainstreams inclusivity and equity across all migration governance areas, ensuring the active participation of women, youth, children, vulnerable groups, and strengthening institutional coordination at national and sub-national levels

Resource Mobilization

The National Migration Policy requires sustainable human, institutional and financial resources to successfully achieve its desired objectives. National and international expertise of individuals and institutions will be sourced in the order and manner adhering to localisation principle that prioritises the use of local experts as a way of promoting local capacity for sustainability. In terms of funding, the Policy will mainly be quite within Government budgetary provisions and allocations. The Government may mobilize additional resources from cooperating partners; private sectors and any other credible alternative funding sources. While NCFRMI is responsible for sourcing the overall policy coordination fund, each lead agency is responsible to provide sectorial budgetary allocation for its areas of concern or mandate in the policy implementation.

Monitoring & Evaluation

The NMP establishes a clear M&E framework coordinated by NCFRMI:

- Comprehensive policy review every five years.
- Annual stakeholder reviews of implementation progress.
- Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) tracked by ministries, departments, agencies, and non-state actors.
- Multi-stakeholder consultations to ensure accountability, transparency, and adaptation to emerging issues.

Policy Governance Structure

The governance structure adopted for the implementation of the Policy is anchored on four levels to ensure the active participation of relevant multi-stakeholder of state and non-state actors including MDAs, CSOs, Trade Unions, Media, Academia and the private sector. They are:



National Consultative Committee (NCC) provides overall political leadership and policy direction, chaired by the Federal Ministry of Justice (FMOJ), the Federal Ministry of Humanitarian Affairs and Poverty Reduction (FMHAPR) or any supervising ministry of National Commission for Refugees, Migrants and Internally Displaced Persons (NCFRMI) with NCFRMI serving as the secretariat.



Technical Working Group (TWG) ensures that the Policy decisions are translated into actionable plans. The TWG is chaired by the NCFRMI, and coordinates various thematic groups focused on specific aspects of migration and the actors - national and international partners

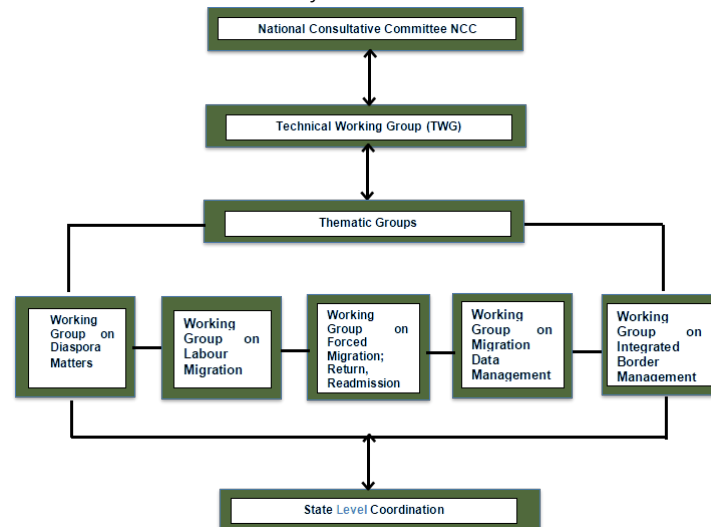


Thematic Work Group - These groups are specialised sub-committees within the TWG, each focusing on a distinct area of migration governance. The thematic groups include:

1. Working Group on Forced Migration, Return, Readmission and Reintegration led by NCFRMI,
2. Working Group on Labour Migration (also known as Technical Working Committee, as provided in the National Policy on Labour Migration) led by the Federal Ministry of Labour and Employment,
3. Working Group on Migration Data Management Strategy - Lead Agency National Population Commission (NPC) and Co-lead: National Bureau of Statistics (NBS),
4. Working Group on Integrated Border Management - Lead Agency: Nigerian Immigration Service (NIS), Co-lead: National Agency for the Prohibition of Trafficking in Persons (NAPTIP)
5. Working Group on Diaspora Engagement, Lead Agency: Nigerians in Diaspora Commission (NiDCOM).



State Coordination - provides for the coordination of migration activities and actors at the state level and is coordinated by the NCFRMI zonal offices.



NATIONAL MIGRATION POLICY INTEGRATED IMPLEMENTATION PLAN (IIP)

To operationalize the revised NMP, the Integrated Implementation Plan (IIP) was developed alongside with the policy review. The IIP is both an action plan for the NMP and Nigeria's National Implementation Plan for the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration (GCM), reflecting Nigeria's commitment as a GCM Champion Country.

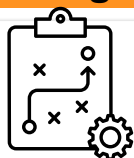
The IIP translates the policy's strategic objectives into concrete and actionable steps, ensuring alignment with national priorities while meeting Nigeria's regional and international obligations. It provides a results-based framework that defines clear roles and responsibilities for all stakeholders, establishes timelines, and outlines monitoring and evaluation mechanisms to track progress. In doing so, the IIP strengthens accountability, promotes effective coordination, and ensures that migration governance contributes to national development goals and the well-being of migrants and communities alike.

Features of the IIP

Objectives



Strategies



Outcome



Activities



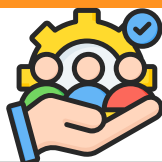
Key Performance Indicators



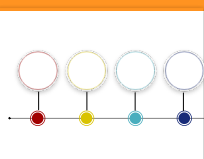
Means of verification



Responsible Actors



Timeline



Purpose of the IIP

- Translate policy objectives into concrete actions.
- Provides a result based implementation framework
- Coordinates roles and responsibilities across stakeholders
- Track progress and evaluate impact of migration intervention
- Assign roles and responsibilities to institutions.
- Define timelines, outputs, and indicators.
- Align national priorities with global frameworks.

Monitoring & Evaluation

- NCFRMI leads overall coordination
- TWG supports Implementation and Review
- Development of a monitoring dashboard for real time data collection